

Commercial Video Guide

A commercial video is a **short, persuasive** video created to promote and pitch your PI-CDIO project, not to explain it in detail.

- ✓ Its main goal is to **attract attention, create emotional connection, and convince the audience of the value of your product or service.**
- ✓ Unlike a demo, which focuses on showing how a product works step by step, **a commercial video focuses on telling a STORY** (problem → solution → impact) and highlighting **benefits** in a simple, engaging way.
- ✓ The aim is not to explain everything, but to make the audience **understand quickly, feel interested, and ACT.**

➤ **The use of pitching techniques is mandatory.**

Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	What is expected:
Hook & Problem	- Strong opening that captures attention immediately - Problem is clear, relatable, and easy to understand - Audience feels the issue (not just explained)
Solution / Value Proposition	- Solution is simple and clearly shown (no technical details) - Strong added value (why it is better than others) - Impactful storytelling (problem → solution → impact is smooth)
Call to Action & Closing	- CTA is clear, short, and impactful (one action only) - CTA feels natural (not forced) - Strong ending with logo + memorable slogan
Image Quality & Visual Clarity	- Clear image (not blurry) - Good lighting and stable shots - Clean visuals (not messy, easy to understand)
Sound Quality & Relevance	- Clear audio (no noise or echo) - Music matches the message and mood - Sound supports the video (not too loud or distracting)

1. Hook (0–15s)

- ✓ The hook is the first 5–10 seconds of the video.
- ✓ Its job is to **make people pay attention**.
- If your hook is weak → people lose interest immediately.

PITCHING TECHNIQUES:

- **QUESTION-BASED:** Start with a question that makes the audience think. This engages curiosity and make the audience reflect.
- **SCENARIO-BASED:** Start with a short story or situation. This creates emotional connection and feels realistic and relatable.
- **STATISTIC-BASED:** Start your video with a number, percentage, or fact to grab attention.

2. Problem (15–45s)

- ✓ The problem is where you show:
 - What is wrong
 - What people struggle with
 - Why your idea is **NEEDED** and **URGENT**.
- Do NOT explain too much, **SHOW** the problem instead of describing it.

PITCHING TECHNIQUES:

- **PAIN-POINT FOCUS:** This technique focuses on **one specific problem** only. The idea is to make the audience understand **the exact difficulty** the user faces. It is narrow, precise, and direct.
- **CHAOS / OVERLOAD:** This technique does not focus on one precise issue. Instead, it shows a person being surrounded by **too many pressures, tasks, signals, or responsibilities etc. at once**. It is broader, more intense, and more visual.
- **Highlight:**
 - a **strong emotion** (stress, frustration, confusion, anxiety)
 - why the same problem happens **repeatedly**
 - what happens **if the problem is not solved**

3. Solution (45–105s)

- ✓ The **Solution** is where you show:
 - How the problem **is solved**
- What your product/service **does:** Do NOT explain technical details - Do NOT show step-by-step demo

- How life becomes **easier**: Ask: “What changes in the person’s life the moment the product-service exists?”

PITCHING TECHNIQUES:

All these three techniques must be used together, but each answers a different question:

- **Friction Removal** → **focuses on the problem** What problem disappears?
- **Effort Collapse** → **focuses on the process** → How easy does it become?
- **Control Restoration** → **focuses on the user** → How does the user feel afterward?

FRICTION REMOVAL: Eliminating obstacles (i.e. This is about what is gone).

EFFORT COLLAPSE: Reducing effort (i.e. This is about how easy things become).

CONTROL RESTORATION: Psychological state of the user (i.e. The user feels in control).

- **THE FORMULA:** Shift → Relief → Control

4. ADDED VALUE (105–135s)

- ✓ The added value answers one key question:
“why should I choose this instead of something else?”
- ✓ It is not about what the product does → It is about why it is **better than existing solutions**.

PITCHING TECHNIQUES:

- **COMPARISON:** Show two things clearly:
 - The existing solution (old / common way) → Do NOT criticize aggressively - Just show limitations.
 - Their solution (new / better way) → Only ADDED VALUE – DO NOT repeat the previous benefits.
- Put them side by side OR one after the other.

5. SDG + IMPACT (135–160s)

- ✓ SDG should answer: “Why does this matter beyond the USER?”
- ✓ Always **embed** the SDG in the narrative
- ✓ DO NOT say:
“This project supports SDG 4” instead show the **IMPACT** visually and naturally.

PITCHING TECHNIQUES:

- **CONTEXTUAL LEGITIMACY:** Place the solution where SDG naturally exists (i.e. embed the solution into schools, workspaces, communities, everyday life systems etc.)
 - The solution feels **real, applicable, and scalable**.
- **OUTCOME VISUALIZATION:** Show the **resulting world**, not the product (i.e. show improved conditions, better behaviors, positive environments etc).

➤ THE FORMULA: Collective Impact → Improved Environment.

6. CTA (160–180s)

- ✓ The CTA says: **aligns desire + removes resistance + triggers action.**
- ✓ The audience does not feel asked → they feel **ready**.
- **LOW-FRICTION CTA** = Remove hesitation.
 - Use words like: **“Start” - “Try” - “Get”**
 - Add a SPEED CUE: **“now” - “in seconds”**
- **IDENTITY-ALIGNED CTA**: Connect action to who the user is (or wants to be).
 - Frame the action as part of identity: People don’t act because of instructions; they act because of **who they believe they are (or want to be)**.
 - Instead of saying: **“Do this”**, say: **“Be this”**
 - Best verbs: **Be, Stay, Keep, Own, Take, Work, Think, Live**
 - Choose one clear identity:
- ✓ Organized, In control, Focused, Productive, Efficient, Smart etc.

7. Recommendation

✓ Recommended Voice Strategy:

- Use your own voice:
- **More authentic** → The audience connects better with a real human voice
- **Stronger emotional impact** → You can express tone (stress, relief, excitement) naturally
- **More convincing** → It feels like a real pitch, not something automated
- **Better storytelling** → Your voice helps carry the *problem* → *solution* → *impact* flow
 - Ensure **voice-over is well-paced and easy to understand**
 - Choose **music that matches the message and mood** of the video
 - Keep **sound balanced** (voice should always be louder than music)
 - Use **sound effects purposefully** (to support actions, not distract)
 - Avoid sudden or inconsistent volume changes

✓ Recommended Image Quality & Visual Clarity:

- Use high-resolution visuals (no pixelation or blurry elements)
- Maintain **clean and simple design** (avoid overcrowded scenes)
- Use a consistent **color palette** by selecting **2–4 main colors** and applying them throughout the video, ensuring they match and reinforce **your logo colors** for a cohesive and professional look.
- Avoid excessive effects (keep it purposeful, not distracting)
- Always keep text readable (proper size and duration on screen)
- Focus on **one idea per scene** (avoid showing too many things at once)